

Plantation Ave vs Lockhart Ln: Buyer Comparison Packet

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The short answer

Both homes cost about the same once you add Lockhart’s fix-up to its price. So this is not a money decision. It is a lifestyle decision.

Lockhart is more house, more land, a shop, a newer build and no flood history. It needs about \$45,000 of work (pool, paint, yard) and some patience. Once restored it is worth more than you paid.

Plantation is finished and beautiful. You move in and you are done. It is in a flood zone and has flooded before, which you will insure for and explain again when you sell.

Our recommendation: write Lockhart first, low, with the seller cleaning the pool and clearing the shop. Keep Plantation as the backup. If Lockhart's inspection turns up more than \$75,000 of work, switch.

Side by side

	Plantation Ave, Denham Springs	Lockhart Ln, Walker
Price	\$549,900	\$534,900
Size	4,000 sq ft, 2 stories	4,327 sq ft, 1 story
Beds and baths	4 bed, 5 full bath	3 bed, 3 full and 2 half bath, two primary suites
Lot	0.7 acre in a subdivision	3.27 acres, no subdivision
Built	1985, renovated, roof 2018	2012, roof 2024
Extras	Pool, outdoor kitchen, balcony, 2-car garage	Saltwater pool, outdoor kitchen and fireplace, 30x50 heated and cooled shop, whole-house generator, RV parking

	Plantation Ave, Denham Springs	Lockhart Ln, Walker
Condition	Move-in ready	Needs pool, paint and yard work
Flood	Zone AE, flooded before this owner, insurance required	Zone X, never flooded in 25 years, insurance optional
Utilities	Public water and sewer, leased propane	Public water, private treatment unit, natural gas
Days on market	62	90, after about \$115,000 in price cuts
Last sale	\$400,000 in 2017	None on record

What each one needs

Plantation is the move-in option. Lockhart is the project with the bigger upside, and its 44 listing photos show the house at its best, not the house you walked.

Plantation: nothing to do before move-in. The photos show a full renovation: white kitchen, new floors, fresh paint, clean pool. The inspection is about the 1985 bones (wiring, plumbing, HVAC) and the rear wall where a pipe leak was repaired. Hold \$5,000 for surprises.

Lockhart: a reset, not a rebuild. The photos show a solid 2012 house with oak cabinets, laminate floors and big primary baths. Today the pool is green and the surface is tired, the yard is overgrown, the paint is scuffed in every room and the shop is full of stuff. None of it is structural. Three things to check hard at inspection: the synthetic stucco exterior, the pool surface (liner or plaster decides the cost) and the sewer treatment unit, which has no service contract.

What Lockhart's fix-up costs

Plan on \$45,000. It could be as low as \$25,000 or as high as \$75,000, and the pool is the swing. These are planning numbers, not bids.

Item	Range
Pool: drain, clean, new liner or resurface, salt cell	\$6,000 to \$22,000

Item	Range
Paint the whole interior	\$9,000 to \$26,000
Cosmetic repairs	\$3,000 to \$8,000
Yard and landscaping	\$5,000 to \$15,000
Shop clear-out, sewer service, inspections	\$1,500 to \$5,000
Total	\$25,000 to \$75,000

Ask the seller to drain and clean the pool and clear the shop before closing. That takes two lines off your list at any price.

Flood

This is the biggest real difference between the two.

	Plantation	Lockhart
Zone	AE, high risk	X, low risk
History	Flooded before the current owner	Never, in 25 years of ownership, including 2016
Insurance	Required. The listing's quote is \$471 a year for \$250,000 of coverage, which is a good number. Re-quote it in your name and add coverage above \$250,000.	Optional. Expect \$500 to \$900 a year if you buy it anyway, which we recommend.
At resale	Every buyer will ask about the flood	A clean record is part of the value

One check on Lockhart: the lot touches a high-risk pocket near the road. The lender's flood determination on the house itself settles it.

Is the price fair

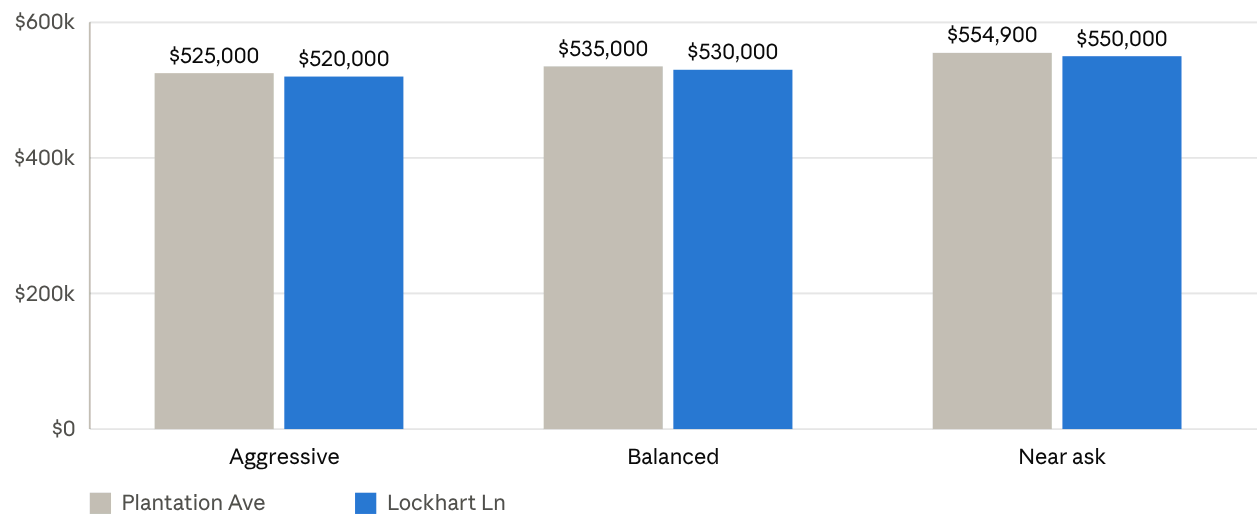
Plantation at \$549,900 is priced right. RPR values it at \$546,750. The seller paid \$400,000 in 2017 and has cut \$10,000 once. Expect to land around \$535,000.

Lockhart at \$534,900 is priced for its condition. It started at \$650,000, which is about what it is worth restored. The seller has already given up \$115,000 and sat 90 days. What is left to negotiate is the fix-up. Expect to land around \$490,000 to \$505,000, with the seller handling the pool and shop.

Offers

Three ways to write each one. The bars show what you actually spend: price, minus any seller credit, plus the fix-up (\$45,000 at Lockhart, \$5,000 at Plantation). They are within \$5,000 of each other at every level.

All-in cost lands within \$5,000 of each other at every offer tier
Offer price, less seller credit, plus planning repairs of \$45,000 at Lockhart and \$5,000 at Plantation



Offer tiers as proposed in this packet, October 1, 2026; repairs from the estimates section

	Low	Middle	Near asking
Plantation offer	\$520,000	\$535,000 with \$5,000 toward closing	\$549,900
Lockhart offer	\$475,000 as-is, seller cleans pool and clears shop	\$500,000 with \$15,000 toward repairs	\$520,000, then ask for \$10,000 to \$20,000 after inspection

	Low	Middle	Near asking
Monthly payment, Plantation	\$2,846	\$2,928	\$3,010
Monthly payment, Lockhart	\$2,600	\$2,737	\$2,846

Payments are principal and interest only, 20 percent down, 30 years at 7.28 percent. Taxes run about \$5,000 a year on either. Add homeowners and flood insurance.

On Lockhart, start low. Ninety days and \$115,000 of cuts say this seller counters, not walks. On Plantation there is less room, so the middle number is the likely landing. Ask the lender about a renovation loan for Lockhart so the fix-up rides in the mortgage.

How to decide

Answer these four and the answer is usually obvious.

- ☐ Do you have \$45,000 for the fix-up after your down payment, or would you need it in the loan?
- ☐ Do you want land, privacy and a shop, or neighbors and a finished house?
- ☐ Is one level with two primary suites worth more to you than four bedrooms on two floors?
- ☐ Are you comfortable buying in a flood zone with a flood history, if the insurance is cheap?

Mostly Lockhart answers: write Lockhart. Mostly Plantation answers: write Plantation.

Before we write an offer

1. Flood: lender's flood determination on Lockhart; Plantation's current policy and a re-quote in your name.
2. Lockhart: a pool contractor says liner or plaster, a stucco inspection is booked, and the agent fixes the structure age on the disclosure.
3. Sold comps from the MLS for both, attached to this packet.

4. Lender: payment at today's rate for each offer, and a renovation loan option for Lockhart.

Fine print

Facts come from the Paragon MLS and RPR reports pulled October 1, 2026, both sellers' property disclosures, the Lockhart survey (May 2025) and sewer disclosure, and the Brightway flood quote for Plantation. Market medians are from Redfin and RPR for August 2026. Repair ranges are from 2026 national cost guides, and the mortgage rate is Freddie Mac's October 1, 2026 average.

Prepared by Caleb Jackson, Keller Williams First Choice. This is a buyer's comparison, not an appraisal, inspection or insurance quote. Every estimate here gets replaced by contractor bids, insurance quotes and a lender's loan estimate before an offer is final.